

Ashwin Sreekumar

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SUMMARY

Public Policy graduate student specializing in local governance, labour market and public finance, with skills in data analytics using R, Julia and QGIS. Experienced in field-based research, survey data management, quantitative modeling, and policy report writing.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Data Analysis: R, Julia, Excel, QGIS

Research Workflow: Git, LaTeX, Zotero

Communication: Policy Report Writing, Data Visualization, Research Documentation

Language: English, Hindi, Malayalam

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Adverse Incorporation or Displacement? Testing the Structural Persistence of Informality and Wage Pass-Through in India's Textile Value Chains | MA Dissertation | 2026

- Conducted a pseudo-panel analysis of repeated cross-sectional surveys of ASI, ASUSE, and NSS datasets to investigate formal-informal sector linkages in India.

Unveiling Gender Gaps in India's Unincorporated Sector | Independent Research | 2026

- Developed a data pipeline using R (tidyverse, survey) and applied complex stratified survey weights to visualize key structural barriers for women entrepreneurs through an analysis of ASUSE dataset.

Market Discrimination Against Marginalized Farmers | Independent Research | 2025

- Analyzed NSS 77th Round microdata on Land and Livestock Holdings (41k+ sales records) investigating multi-layered market discrimination against SC/ST farmers using Quantile Regressions and District Fixed Effects.

Social Capital and Employment Outcomes in Rural India | Independent Research | 2025

- Analyzed impact of social and cultural capital on employment outcomes across social groups using IHDS-II data, focusing on disparities for marginalized communities

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant | Foundation for Agrarian Studies | June, 2026 – Present

- Provide assistance to the study on Digital Agriculture in India, including literature review, data processing, and analysis.
- Assist in field surveys, archiving survey data, and preparing project deliverables including presentations and manuscripts.
- Process and analyse survey data using R and QGIS, contributing to policy-relevant research outputs.

Research Intern | Foundation for Agrarian Studies | April, 2026 – June, 2026

- Analyzed Census and Mission Antyodaya datasets to identify priority villages for survey deployment.
- Developed state-level agricultural profiles by consolidating administrative data from multiple agricultural institutes and research organisations.
- Mapped climate risk-prone zones in Indian agriculture using QGIS, contributing to vulnerability assessment and planning.

Research Intern | Veditum India Foundation | June 2025 – August 2025

- Prepared comprehensive Policy Review Report for Madhya Pradesh sand mining policy using qualitative research methods.
- Conducted archival research and data collection of official, legal, and media documents related to river sand mining.

Research Intern | IndiaSpend | April 2025 – May 2025

- Supported journalists with data analysis, literature review, and research documentation tasks.
- Explored reports, policy documents and academic research to prepare story pitches.

Intern | Praja Foundation | January 2024 – March 2024

- Executed governance-related RTI data collection across Urban Local Bodies.
- Researched Urban Local Bodies' budgeting processes and financial management practices.
- Developed data visualizations for research findings and conference presentations.

PRESENTATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Participant | 1st Agent-based Modeling India Workshop | IIM Kozhikode | March 2025

- Intensive two-day workshop led by Dr. Robert Axtell (George Mason University) exploring agent-based modeling techniques for policy analysis

Conference Presentation | 49th Annual All India Sociological Conference | BML Munjal University | 2024

- Presented paper: *Devalued Labor, Valued Property: Urban Land Politics and Working Class Aspirations*
- Examined intersection of housing policies and working-class political aspirations through primary fieldwork

First Prize Winner | Jigyasa Annual Physics Exhibition | St. Xavier's College, Mumbai | 2022

- Project: *Application of Ising Model in Voting Mechanisms* – Our team applied a mathematical model of ferromagnetism in statistical mechanics to study voting mechanisms

EDUCATION

Master of Arts in Public Policy | CHRIST (Deemed to be University), Bangalore | 2024 – 2026

Bachelor of Science in Physics | St. Xavier's College, Mumbai | 2020 – 2023

CERTIFICATIONS

Google Data Analytics Specialization | Coursera | Skills: R, SQL, Tableau, Google Sheets

